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Startup Starter

Launch Your Startup: From Idea to Market Value

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Startup Starter Path:
Key Steps of Startup Development

1. **Idea**
2. **Sketch/Prototype/MVP**
3. **User Feedback (Mom/Friends/Actual Users)**
4. **Update/Change Product***
5. **Marketing Strategy/ Financial Model/Team (Business Plan)**
6. **Deck and Pitch (Your Ask)**
7. Launch
8. Users/Revenue
9. Growth
10. Achieve Unicorn Status

Product (Supply) < > Customer (Demand)

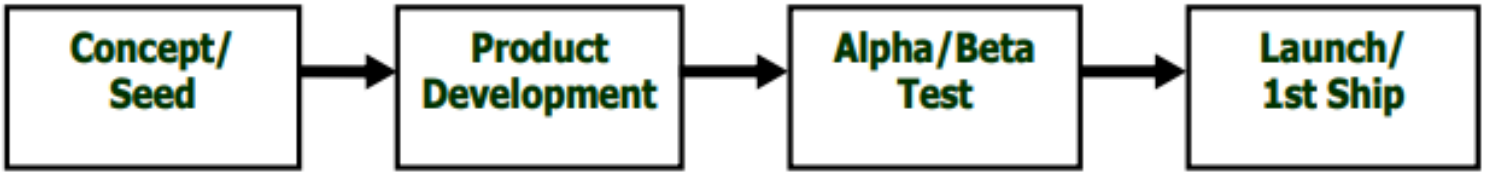


Figure 1.1 The Product Development Diagram

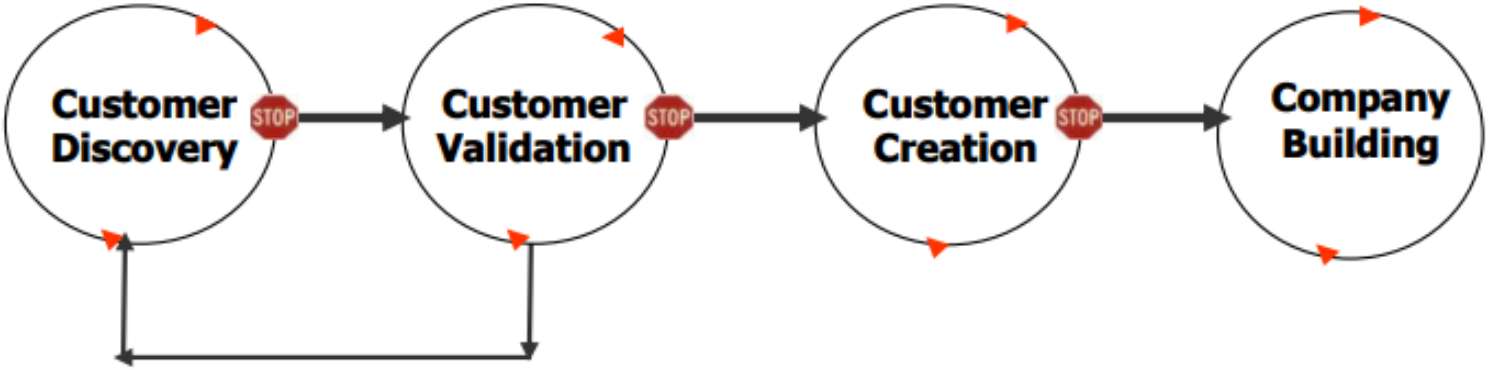


Figure 2.1 The Customer Development Model

"If you're starting a company, chances are you can build a product. Almost every failed startup has a product. What failed startups don't have is enough customers."

Marc Andreessen

"The number one reason that we pass on entrepreneurs we'd otherwise like to back is they're focusing on product to the exclusion of everything else.

Many entrepreneurs who build great products simply don't have a good distribution strategy."

andreessen. horowitz

Store your Photos

Share your Photos

Changes YOUR thinking
about the product

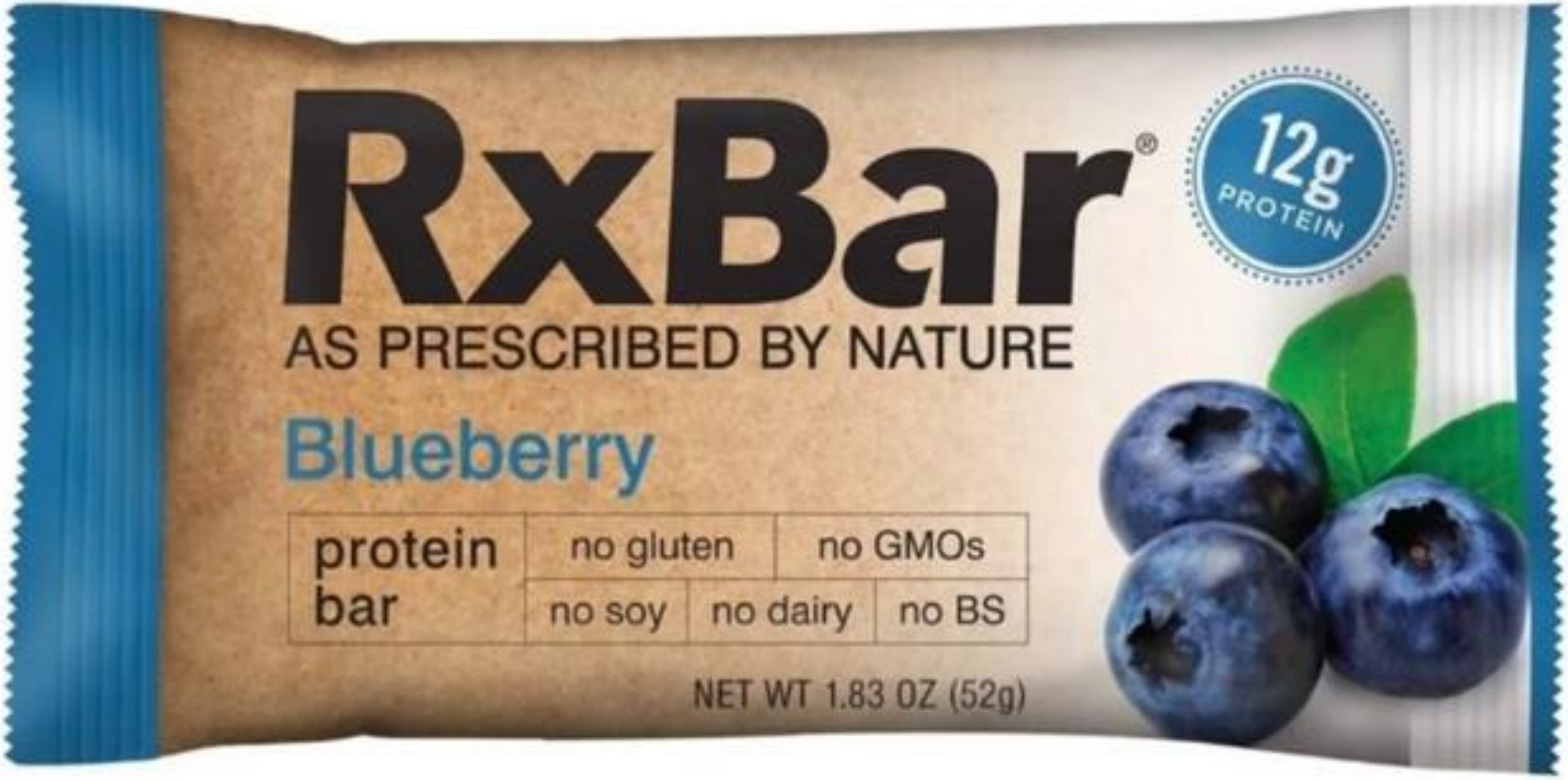
James Currier: 47 million users in 6 months

The Market: The Requirements

1. Discovering/Identifying Your **Users** or Customers (this is your **market**). Your market includes your users (and their unique personas) and the current alternatives available to your users (called **competition**). **WHO DEFINES YOUR MARKET? WHERE/WHAT IS YOUR MARKET (positioning)?**

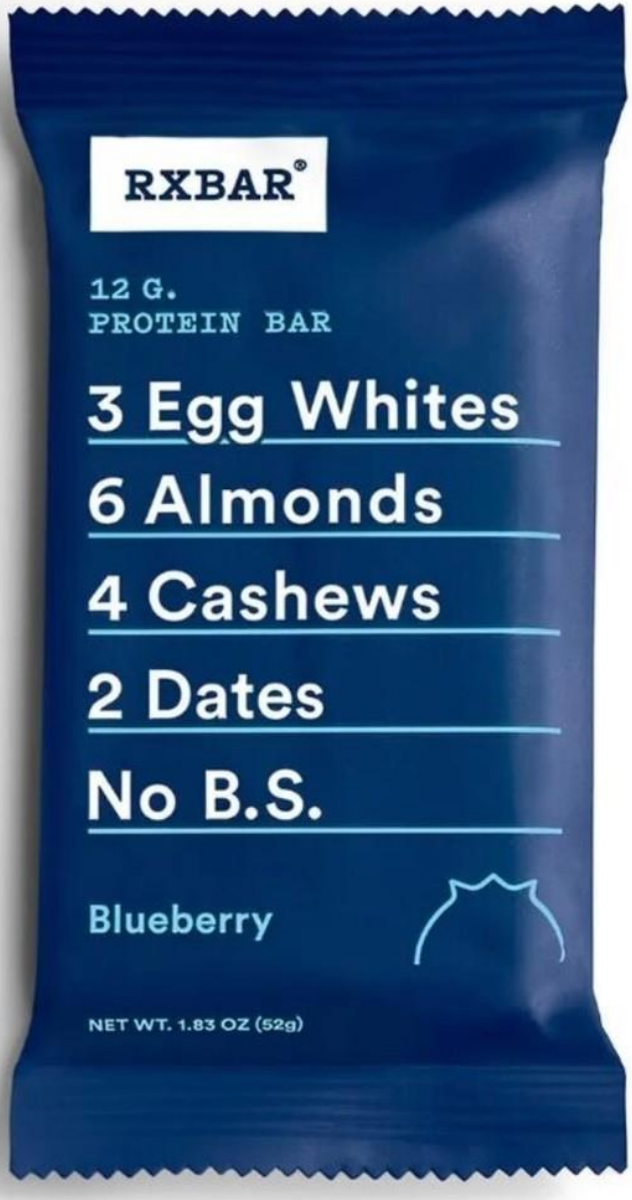
2. Figuring Out How Many Customers You Could Have (this is how **big** your market is, which determines potential revenue). **TAM, SAM, and SOM. HOW BIG IS YOUR MARKET?**

3. Figuring Out How to Message Your Customers (this is called **Marketing**). **HOW DO YOU GET THEM TO REALIZE YOU EXIST AND CAN SATISFY THEIR NEEDS/WANTS?**


RxBar®
AS PRESCRIBED BY NATURE
Blueberry
protein bar
no gluten
no GMOs
no soy
no dairy
no BS
NET WT 1.83 OZ (52g)
12g PROTEIN

FAILURE

$650M!!!



Go To Market: Marketing

Marketing: The core strategies companies use to reach and communicate with customers.

Lays the foundation for how a company engages with its target customers.

Includes **channels** to convey your message to potential buyers, which include any types of communication to create **awareness** and **interest**.

Examples: Call them. Email them. YouTube them. Tik Tok them. (advertise to them).

Who wants to be
fishing friends?
-Ryan
NewToMissoula.com
MAR 70012
STOP

Looking for a
Kayaking compadre?
-Ryan
NewToMissoula.com
LAMAR 80292

Let's be
biking buddies!
-Ryan
NewToMissoula.com

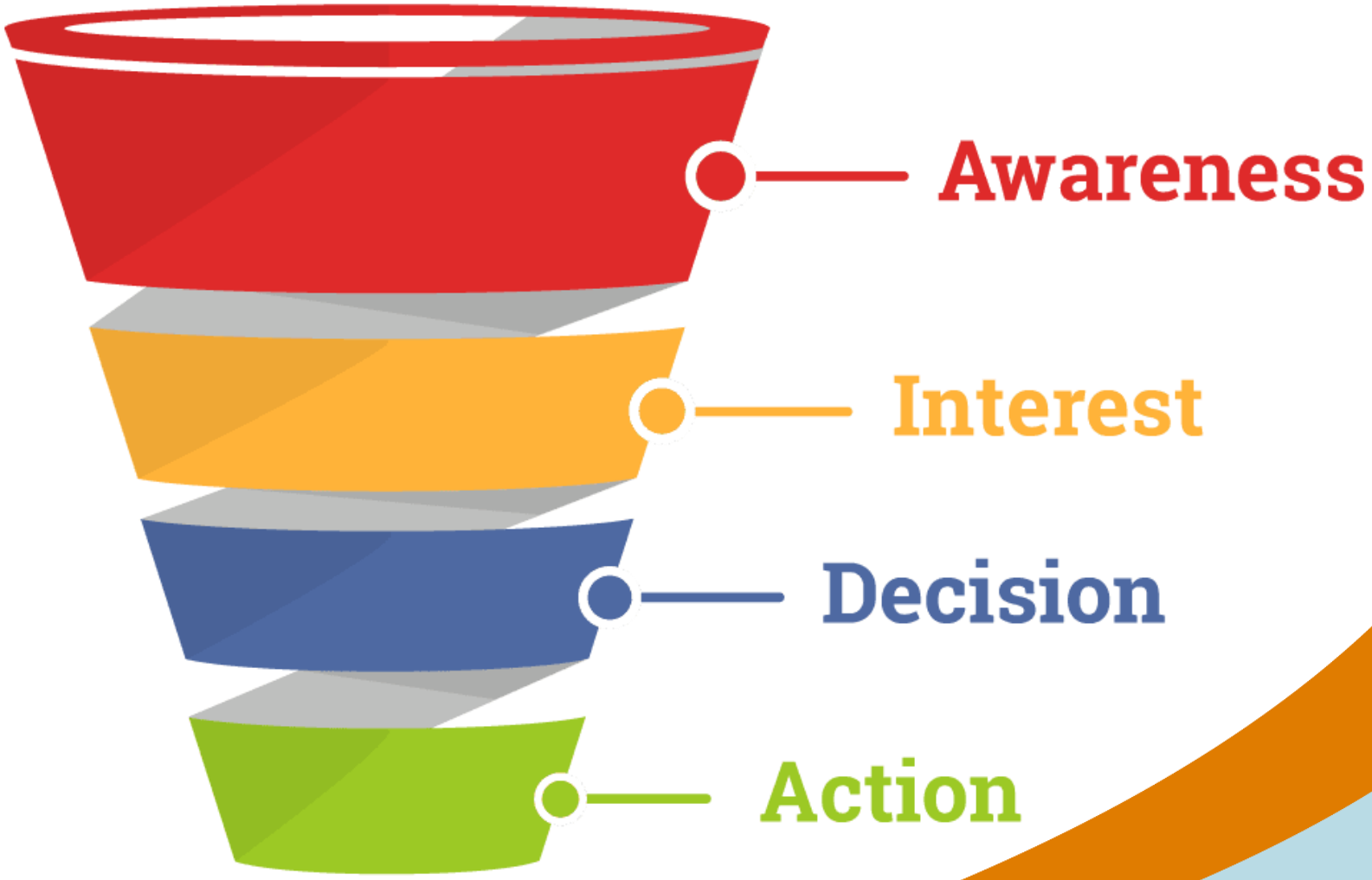
Winter B
WHO WANTS TO BE
FISHING FRIENDS?
Ryan
NEW TO MISSOULA.COM
NEW TO MISSOULA.COM
NEW TO MISSOULA.COM
NEW TO MISSOULA.COM
NEW TO MISSOULA.COM

Sales and Growth (Traction) Models

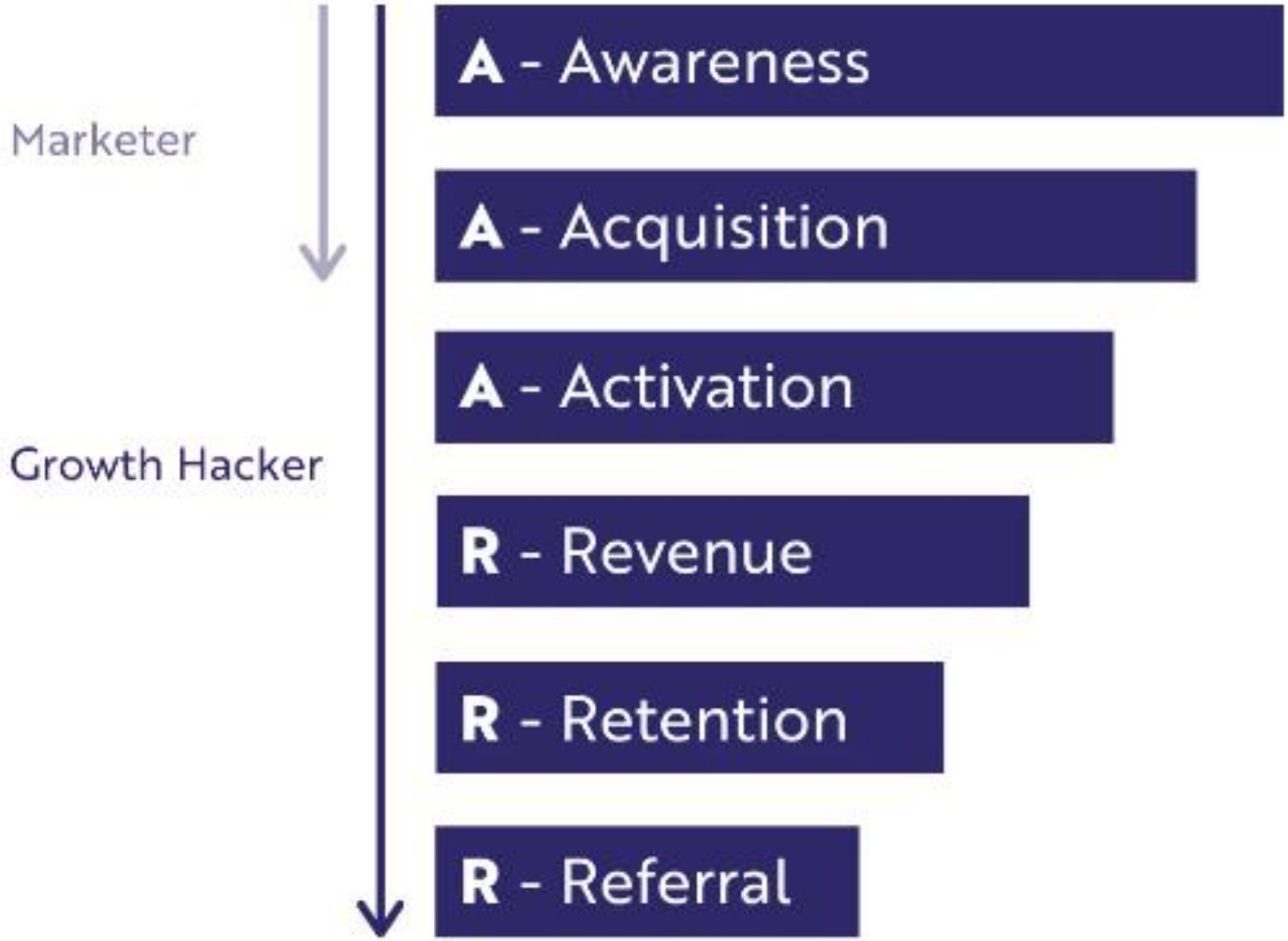
AIDA Model (Attention, Interest, Decision, Action)

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L5hIR3-jAIs

The Funnel (Awareness-to-Action)



The Pirate Funnel (AAARRR)



Traction Channels (you literally have at least 19 options)

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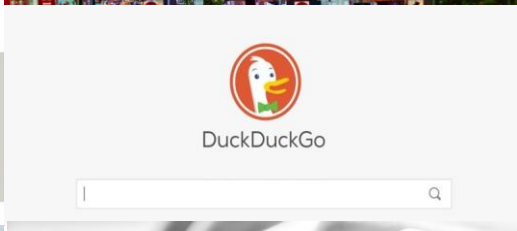
BLOGS


DuckDuckGo

RedBull
RedBull

SXSW REGISTRATION

SEM
SEARCH ENGINE
MARKETING

TECH REVIEW
CLOUD COMPUTING
How Cloud Computing Will Change Business
Making Sense of Using Social Media
Scientists Create Brain Cells
YOUR AD HERE
2012 World's Census of the Population
What Was the Best TV Show of 2012?
Winter Car Maintenance Tips
Market Data

The 19 Traction Channels

1. **Targeting Blogs.** Target niche blogs. Can acquire customers before launching.
2. **Publicity**. Getting your name out via traditional media like newspapers, magazines, and TV, or via social media. Requires relationships with reporters, influencers, etc.
3. **Unconventional PR.** Exceptional attempts like publicity stunts or going above and beyond for your customers.
4. **SEM**. Search Engine Marketing. Advertise to buyers searching on Google and other search engines.
5. **Social and Display Ads.** Ads on popular sites like reddit, YouTube, Facebook, Twitter, and hundreds of other niche sites.
6. **Offline Ads.** TV spots, radio commercials, **billboards**, infomercials, newspaper ads, magazine ads, flyers, and local advertisements. Especially powerful for less tech-savvy users.
7. **SEO**. Search engine optimization. Web site shows as part of key search results. Includes how to use SEO cheaply.
8. **Content Marketing**. Using website and blogs to get traction.
9. **Email Marketing**. Email campaigns.
10. **Engineering as Marketing**. Significantly underutilized way to get traction. Includes microsites, widgets, free tools, etc., that drive leads each month. Free tier of basic services, etc.

11. **Viral Marketing**. Growing customers through word of mouth. Customers referring other customers. Conspicuous consumption.
12. **Business Development**. Creating strategic relationships that benefit you and your partner. Involved finding strategic partners, building a business development pipeline, and approaching potential partners.
13. **Sales**. Finding early customers and finding willing sales conversions.
14. **Affiliate Programs**. Involves finding programs to promote your product to reach hundreds of thousands of customers.
15. **Existing Platforms**. Find megaplatforms, including app stores, to get product in front of millions.
16. **Trade Shows**. Show product in front of industry participants.
17. **Offline Events**. Sponsor or run an offline event. Ranges from small meetings to large conferences.
18. **Speaking Engagements**. Speak at events, give talks, and grow your startup's profile.
19. **Community Building**. Form passionate communities around your product.

UM/WCU Startup Starter Entrepreneurship Course.

https://forms.gle/d2QU6S5S3QyCF1nz8

Scan the QR code to register for the course.

This free course is open to students and community members with a business idea. Space is limited to 10 participants.

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Course Schedule

5:30 — 7:30pm

WEEK 1 – NOV 12:
Finding Your Idea or Opportunity

WEEK 2 – NOV 19:
Testing Your Idea
(Customer Development)

WEEK 3 – NOV 25:
Nov 25: Reaching Your Customers
(Marketing & Sales)

WEEK 4 – DEC 3:
Your Business Model & Financials

WEEK 5 – DEC 10:
Pitching Your Idea

FINAL EVENT – DEC 11:
Pitch Showcase @ WCU

Activity: The Bullseye Model

1. Go through the list of Traction channels. Brainstorm (co-creation with your favorite AI tool is highly suggested) **specific** ideas for each channel based on your startup idea.
2. Select the 3 channels that seem best suited for your idea and lend themselves to multiple options for testing.
3. Select 1 main channel that you think would be the best way to reach your target customers.
4. Share with a partner.

ChatGPT 5.1

Do you know the 19 channels from Traction?

Yes. *Traction* by Gabriel Weinberg and Justin Mares identifies **19 traction channels**—systematic ways to acquire and grow customers. Here they are, grouped and explained clearly:

If you want, I can:

- Help build a **Traction Map** or Bullseye Framework
- Rank them for **your specific GTM strategy**
- Give examples and metrics for each

Would you like that?

Homework: Your Marketing Campaign

1. Choose 1 channel to focus on. Develop **an initial outline** of a marketing strategy based on this 1 channel.

2. Develop this strategy into a simple campaign: short video, Instagram photo, PR campaign, etc.

3. Work on this campaign. And then launch. Examples: Advertising in Missoulian, post on TikTok, upload to Instagram, video PR stunt in Missoula (**Jenny**).

4. Share results next week.

Schedule

- **Week 1 – Nov 12:** *Finding Your Idea or Opportunity*
  Discover how to spot market gaps and refine your business concept.
- **Week 2 – Nov 19:** *Testing Your Idea (Customer Development)*
  Learn how to validate your idea through real-world feedback.
- **Week 3 – Tues, Nov 25:** *Reaching Your Customers (Marketing & Sales)*
  Build a marketing plan that connects your product with your audience.
- **Week 4 – Dec 3:** *Your Business Model & Financials*
  Design a business model that works and understand the numbers behind it.
- **Week 5 – Dec 10:** *Pitching Your Idea*
  Create your pitch deck and practice your delivery.

- **Final Event – Thurs, Dec 11:** *Pitch Showcase to small group of decision-makers @ WCU*